the NSAB is now tasked with analysing issues of critical importance for the National Security Council. Over the last several years, the NSAB, like the national security adviser, has spent the bulk of its time on issues of internal security. It has also written reports on defence preparedness, on the threats from China, the growing importance of Myanmar and even a draft national security doctrine. Ideally, the think tank's reports should find their way to the Cabinet Committee on Security for consideration in policy discussions. However, incumbent officials tend to ignore the analysis of non-governmental experts and retired officials who make up the NSAB, making it less effective as an advisory body than was intended.

COORDINATING NATIONAL SECURITY

The reluctance of an entrenched bureaucracy to yield space is the reason why India took so long after 1947 to create additional structures for policymaking. For example, the idea of an adviser to the prime minister on foreign and security policy issues is not new and has been around since Independence. Nehru's appointment of a Secretary General at the Ministry of External Affairs was meant to put in position someone having trust of the prime minister and knowledge of the Indian system. Nehru rarely sought advice and the Secretary General ended up becoming just another tier in the MEA bureaucracy created by the British. Indira Gandhi created the position of chairman of the Policy Planning Committee to help her formulate foreign policy while other prime ministers relied on advisers within the PMO. However, it took several decades before a national security adviser could be appointed and the edifice left in place by the British was subjected to any serious revision.

Even now, bureaucratic rivalries persist as to whether the national security adviser should always be a foreign service officer or the task can be handled by someone other than a civil service mandarin. Those favouring reservation of the position for an eminent former diplomat claim that it is